

How to Recover From Burnout - Printable Sheets

From *How to Recover From Burnout* by Hannah Kessler (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need.

Keep these together. The monthly ones are the point - a single reading tells you almost nothing, and three in a row tells you the direction.

THE BURNOUT SELF-CHECK

Score 0 (never) to 4 (daily). Repeat monthly and write each month in a new column.

Exhaustion

	Mth 1	Mth 2	Mth 3	Mth 4
Emotionally drained by my work				
Tired on getting up, facing another day				
Working all day is a real strain				
Used up at the end of the day				
Rest does not restore me				
Exhaustion total (0-20)				

Cynicism and distance

	Mth 1	Mth 2	Mth 3	Mth 4
Less interested than when I started				
Less enthusiastic about the work				
More callous towards people				
I doubt the significance of my work				

I just want to do the job and not be bothered				
Cynicism total (0-20)				

Professional efficacy - score these REVERSED (0 if daily, 4 if never)

	Mth 1	Mth 2	Mth 3	Mth 4
I solve the problems that arise effectively				
I make an effective contribution				
I am good at my job				
I feel good when I accomplish something				
I have accomplished worthwhile things here				
Low-efficacy total (0-20)				

Highest dimension this month: _____

THE SIX MISMATCHES

Score 0-10, where 10 is a severe mismatch. Then mark what can actually move.

Mismatch	Score	Movable by me	By negotiation	Not here
Workload - more than fits, without recovery				
Control - a say in how, when, what order				
Reward - recognised in any way at all				
Community - support, or conflict and isolation				
Fairness - decisions made justly				
Values - asked to do what I think is wrong				

My highest two: _____ and _____

Is either in the "not here" column? _____

If your highest mismatch is **values** or **fairness**, a workload remedy will not touch it. That is the single most expensive mistake in this subject.

MY MINIMUM VIABLE LIFE

If I had half my capacity - and I do - what would I keep?

LOAD-BEARING (real consequences if dropped - usually five or six things)

LOOKS LOAD-BEARING, IS NOT (this is where recovery lives)

ACTIVELY DRAINING (these go first)

RESTORATIVE (protect at least one, daily)

For the next six weeks: nothing new - standards deliberately lowered - one hard thing a day maximum - one restorative thing protected daily.

DROP, DEFER, DELEGATE

DROP - not later, at all	DEFER - to a stated date	DELEGATE - to whom, by when

Delegation check: have I handed over the worry as well as the task? _____

Whole domains work. Single tasks leave you holding the planning.

THE SLEEP LINE

Two weeks. No device needed. Sleep improves before mood does, which makes this the earliest evidence that recovery is underway.

Day	To bed	Roughly asleep	Woke	Out of 5
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				

13				
14				

My fixed wake time, seven days a week: _____

No work email after: _____

THE WORKLOAD CONVERSATION

Fill this in before you go in. The list is the part that works.

Everything currently on me, with hours per week

Task / responsibility	Hrs/wk
TOTAL	

My contracted hours: _____ **The gap:** _____

The consequence, stated factually (errors, quality, sleep - not feelings)

My specific ask (one or two things, time-bound)

My fallback if refused

The question if the answer is no: *"What would need to be true for this to change, and when could we look at it again?"*

After the meeting - the email confirming what was agreed.

Sent? _____

MY EARLY WARNING SIGNALS

Write these now, while you remember them. Yours are the ones from last time.

My signals	
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	

THE TWO-SIGNAL RULE: one signal is noise. **Two in the same month is an instruction to act this week** - cut something, protect sleep. Three means have the workload conversation again.

Decided now, by a rested person, so it does not have to be decided later by a depleted one.

THE MONTHLY CHECK

Same date each month. Ten minutes. Put it in the calendar with a reminder.

	Mth 1	Mth 2	Mth 3	Mth 4	Mth 5	Mth 6
Sleep vs last month (better / same / worse)						

Which dimension is creeping						
Limits kept, or eroded						
Which mismatch has moved						
Still doing the restorative thing						
Signals this month (count)						

Oro Enigma Publishing. This pack is for personal use. It is not medical advice; see the note at the front of the book.